

TidyTuesday Week 35

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Friday 28th August, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly parade of economic non sequiturs, where a computer flings two innocent time series into a blender and we all pretend to be surprised by the smoothie. This week the machine got creative, and by "creative" I mean it paired up things that have never once been in the same room. Buckle up.

Monday kicked us off by wedding "Other Business Receivables Owned by Finance Companies" to a nonfarm employment diffusion index, and the relationship was so weak it barely qualified as an acquaintance. R-squared of 0.006, p-value hovering around 0.10, and detrending did absolutely nothing to rescue it. Two series that looked at each other, shrugged, and walked away. Tuesday somehow did even less: pairing auto production seasonal factors with Romanian reissue patents produced a glorious wall of NaNs, which is the statistical equivalent of the model filing for divorce before the wedding. Nothing to see here, which is honestly on brand.

Then Wednesday and Thursday actually made me sit up. The San Francisco Tech Pulse versus the labor force of women with master's degrees showed a raw relationship that, remarkably, got STRONGER after detrending (R-squared climbing from 0.10 to 0.14, p-value diving into the billionths) – so that one isn't just two things drifting upward together, there's some genuine wiggle-matching going on. And Thursday was the showstopper: an Employment Cost Index for manufacturing professionals against the price of groceries, sporting a raw R-squared of 0.95 that will make any layperson gasp. Cooler heads note it deflates to 0.43 once you strip the trends – so most of that jaw-dropper was just two things marching upward through time like everything else in a modern economy – but 0.43 with a laughably tiny p-value still holds up as a real link. Wages and food prices moving together? Groundbreaking. Someone alert an economist, they'll be so relieved to hear that inflation is, in fact, inflation.

Friday closed us out gently, with credit intermediation prices and department store sales sharing all the chemistry of two strangers in an elevator: nothing significant, raw or detrended, and department stores continuing their proud tradition of not correlating with anything, including their own survival. As always, the mandatory reminder: these pairings are drawn at random, none of this implies causation, and the whole point of the exercise is to watch spurious correlations strut around in a lab coat. When something like the grocery-wage link survives detrending, we raise an eyebrow; when it doesn't, we point and laugh. This week gave us both, which is about as good as random noise gets. See you next week for more.

2 Date: 2026-08-24

Series ID: DTBOOXDFBANM

This series is titled Other Business Receivables Owned by Finance Companies, Flow and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars, Monthly Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1980-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: SMS000000000000000022

This series is titled Diffusion Indexes, 3-Month Span: Total Nonfarm and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1991-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 17.

2.1 Raw Regression

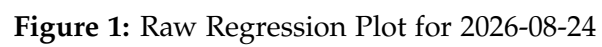
Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SMS000000000000000022	R-squared:	0.007			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.004			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.780			
Date:	Mon, 24 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0962			
Time:	12:21:23	Log-Likelihood:	-1980.1			
No. Observations:	425	AIC:	3964.			
Df Residuals:	423	BIC:	3972.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	76.2916	1.244	61.331	0.000	73.847	78.737
value_fred_DTBOOXDFBANM	0.0009	0.001	1.667	0.096	-0.000	0.002
Omnibus:	115.402	Durbin-Watson:	0.217			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	214.702			
Skew:	-1.569	Prob(JB):	2.39e-47			
Kurtosis:	4.511	Cond. No.	2.40e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.4e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SMS00000000000000022_detrended	R-squared:	0.006
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.004
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.758
Date:	Mon, 24 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0975
Time:	12:21:24	Log-Likelihood:	-1980.1
No. Observations:	425	AIC:	3964.
Df Residuals:	423	BIC:	3972.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.49e-14	1.242	3.62e-14	1.000	-2.441	2.441
value_fred_DTBOOXDFBANM_detrended	0.0009	0.001	1.661	0.098	-0.000	0.002

Omnibus:	115.439	Durbin-Watson:	0.217
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	214.833
Skew:	-1.569	Prob(JB):	2.24e-47
Kurtosis:	4.513	Cond. No.	2.39e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.39e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

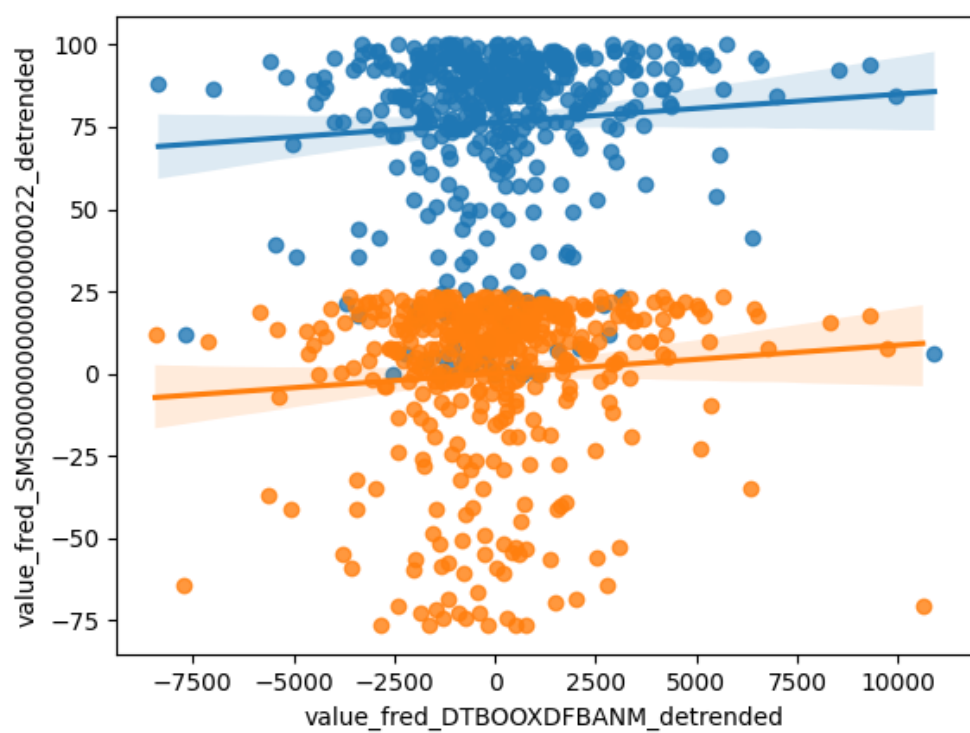


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-24

3 Date: 2026-08-25

Series ID: G17MVSFAUTOS

This series is titled Regular Seasonal Factors: Auto Production and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Seasonal Factor and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2027-09-01. The popularity of this series is 4.

Series ID: PATENT4NROREISSUE

This series is titled U.S. Granted Patents: Reissue Patents Originating in Romania and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Number and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1993-01-01 and the observation end date is 2020-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PATENT4NROREISSUE	R-squared:	nan
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	nan
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	nan
Date:	Tue, 25 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	nan
Time:	12:22:02	Log-Likelihood:	inf
No. Observations:	25	AIC:	-inf
Df Residuals:	23	BIC:	-inf
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	0	0	nan	nan	0	0
value_fred_G17MVSFAUTOS	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	nan	Durbin-Watson:	nan
Prob(Omnibus):	nan	Jarque-Bera (JB):	nan
Skew:	nan	Prob(JB):	nan
Kurtosis:	nan	Cond. No.	2.33e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.33e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

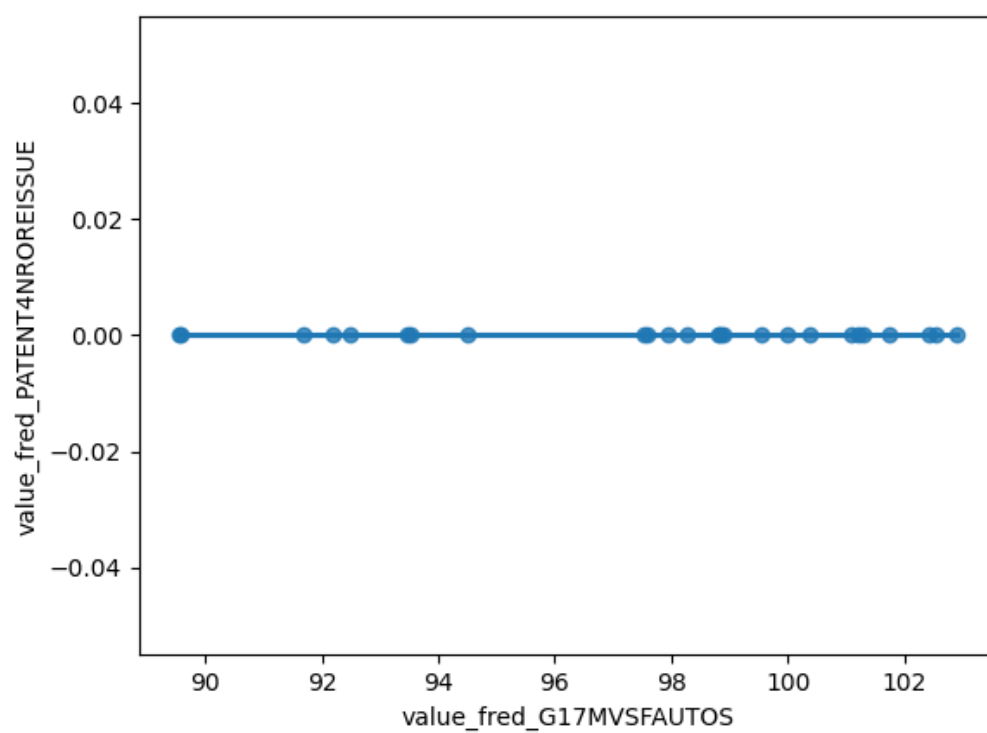


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-25

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PATENT4NRROREISSUE_detrended	R-squared:	nan
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	nan
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	nan
Date:	Tue, 25 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	nan
Time:	12:22:03	Log-Likelihood:	inf
No. Observations:	25	AIC:	-inf
Df Residuals:	23	BIC:	-inf
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	0	0	nan	nan	0	0
value_fred_G17MVSFAUTOS_detrended	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	nan	Durbin-Watson:	nan
Prob(Omnibus):	nan	Jarque-Bera (JB):	nan
Skew:	nan	Prob(JB):	nan
Kurtosis:	nan	Cond. No.	3.92

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

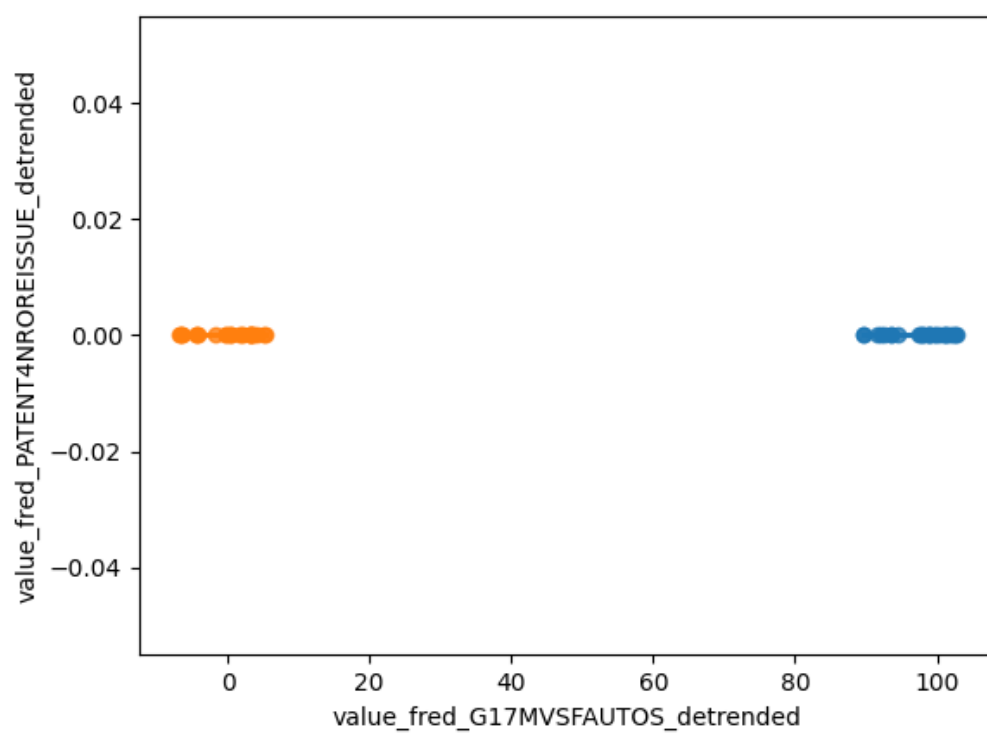


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-25

4 Date: 2026-08-26

Series ID: SFTPINDM114SFRBSF

This series is titled San Francisco Tech Pulse (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jan 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1971-04-01 and the observation end date is 2020-03-01. The popularity of this series is 9.

Series ID: CGMDLW2564

This series is titled Civilian Labor Force - College Graduates - Master's Degree, 25 to 64 years, Women and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Thousands of Persons and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CGMDLW2564	R-squared:	0.100
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.096
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	26.65
Date:	Wed, 26 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.10e-07
Time:	12:24:10	Log-Likelihood:	-2072.8
No. Observations:	243	AIC:	4150.
Df Residuals:	241	BIC:	4157.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	3082.1539	563.746	5.467	0.000	1971.655	4192.653
value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF	34.1431	6.614	5.162	0.000	21.115	47.172

Omnibus:	8.541	Durbin-Watson:	0.010
Prob(Omnibus):	0.014	Jarque-Bera (JB):	8.940
Skew:	-0.458	Prob(JB):	0.0114
Kurtosis:	2.789	Cond. No.	609.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

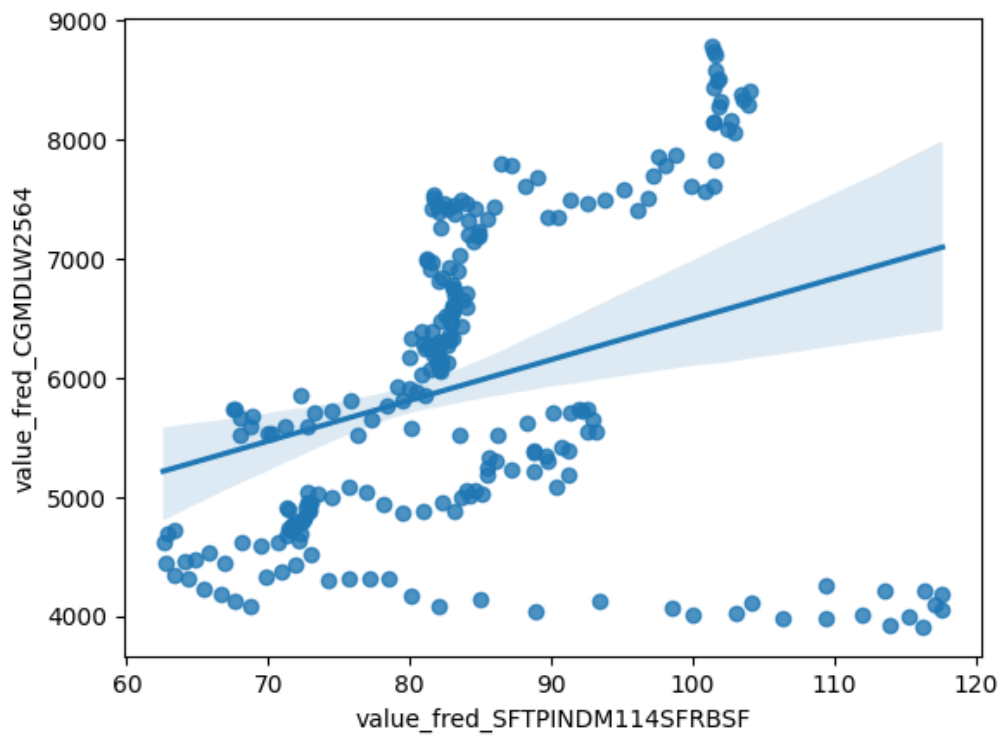


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-26

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CGMDLW2564_detrended	R-squared:	0.136
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.132
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	37.94
Date:	Wed, 26 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.04e-09
Time:	12:24:10	Log-Likelihood:	-1604.9
No. Observations:	243	AIC:	3214.
Df Residuals:	241	BIC:	3221.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-3.482e-11	11.508	-3.03e-12	1.000	-22.668	22.668
value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF_detrended	6.1602	1.000	6.159	0.000	4.190	8.130

Omnibus:	7.909	Durbin-Watson:	0.417
Prob(Omnibus):	0.019	Jarque-Bera (JB):	9.938
Skew:	0.259	Prob(JB):	0.00695
Kurtosis:	3.845	Cond. No.	11.5

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

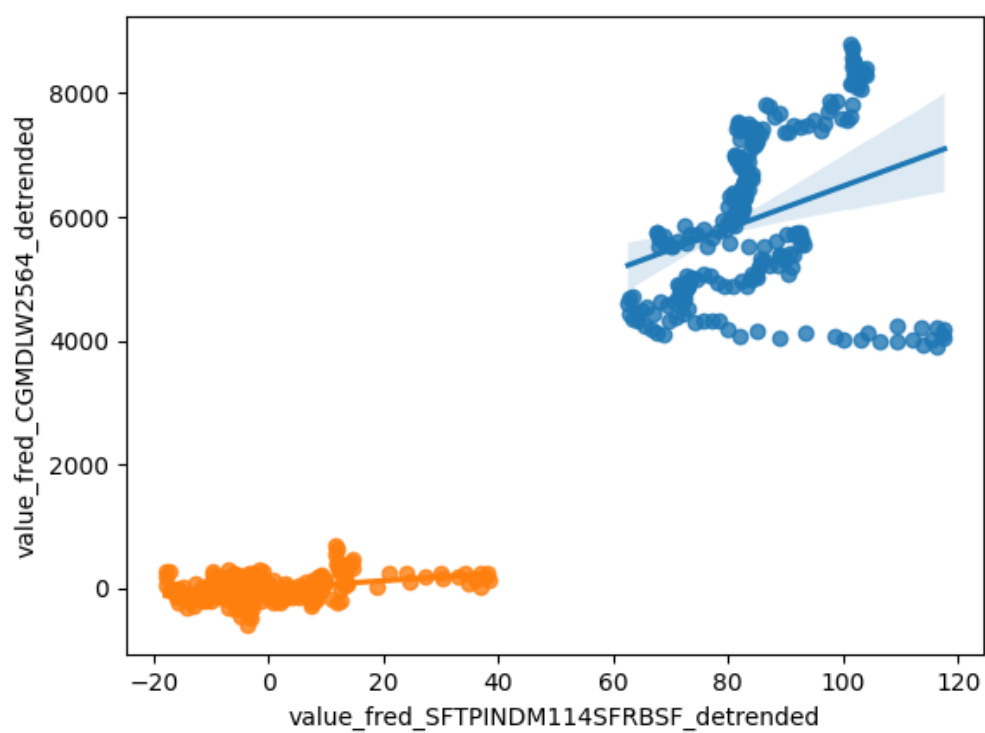


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-26

5 Date: 2026-08-27

Series ID: CIU2013000100000I

This series is titled Employment Cost Index: Total compensation for Private industry workers in Manufacturing; management, professional, and related occupations and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index Dec 2005=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2001-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: CWSR0000SAF11

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers: Food at Home in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 1982-1984=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1952-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CWSR0000SAF11	R-squared:	0.952			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.951			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1958.			
Date:	Thu, 27 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	4.92e-67			
Time:	21:22:56	Log-Likelihood:	-363.32			
No. Observations:	101	AIC:	730.6			
Df Residuals:	99	BIC:	735.9			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	10.1646	5.080	2.001	0.048	0.085	20.245
value_fred_CIU2013000100000I	1.8620	0.042	44.250	0.000	1.779	1.946
	Omnibus:	5.948	Durbin-Watson:	0.072		
	Prob(Omnibus):	0.051	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.044		
	Skew:	-0.455	Prob(JB):	0.0803		
	Kurtosis:	2.391	Cond. No.	691.		

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

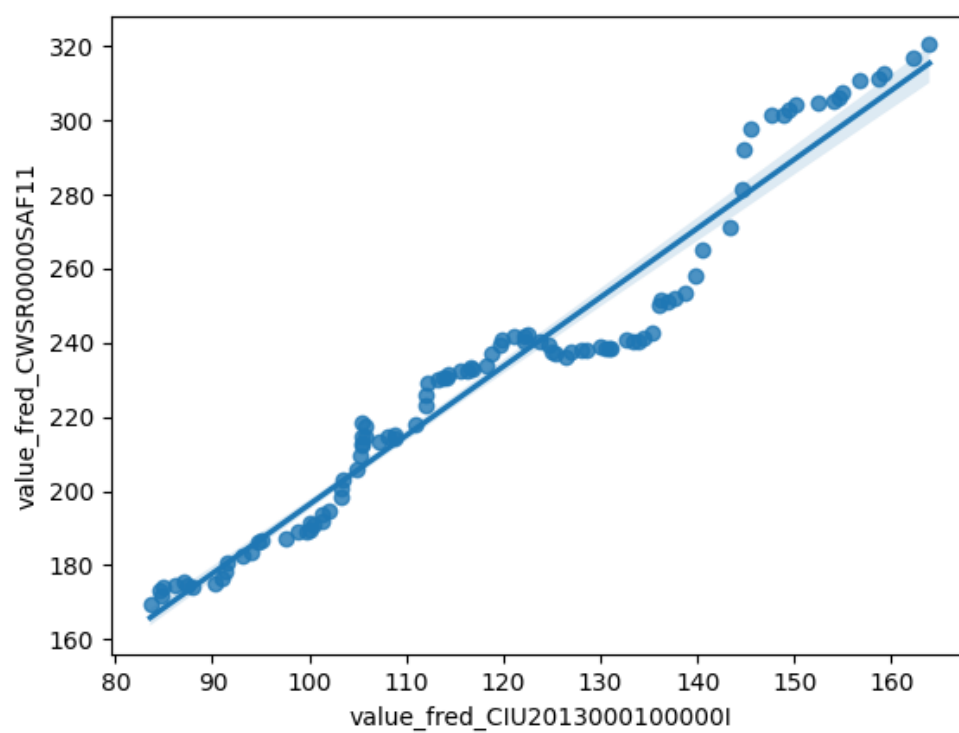


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-27

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CWSR0000SAF11_detrended	R-squared:	0.434
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.428
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	75.78
Date:	Thu, 27 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	7.23e-14
Time:	21:22:57	Log-Likelihood:	-358.47
No. Observations:	101	AIC:	720.9
Df Residuals:	99	BIC:	726.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.722e-12	0.846	-2.04e-12	1.000	-1.679	1.679
value_fred_CIU2013000100000I_detrended	2.9108	0.334	8.705	0.000	2.247	3.574

Omnibus:	16.748	Durbin-Watson:	0.103
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	4.910
Skew:	-0.158	Prob(JB):	0.0859
Kurtosis:	1.967	Cond. No.	2.53

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

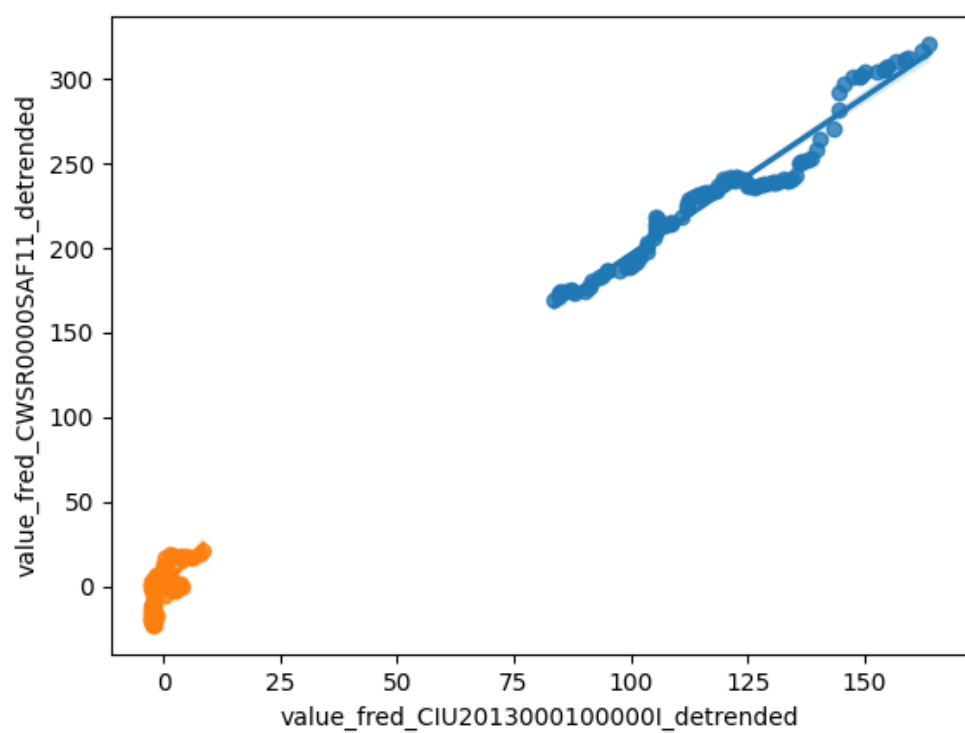


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-27

6 Date: 2026-08-28

Series ID: WPU39

This series is titled Producer Price Index by Commodity: Credit Intermediation Services (Partial) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jun 2009=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2009-06-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: 4522MPCSMN

This series is titled Advance Retail Sales: Department Stores and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Percent Change from Preceding Period and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1992-02-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

6.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_4522MPCSMN	R-squared:	0.007
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.002
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.349
Date:	Fri, 28 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.247
Time:	21:35:13	Log-Likelihood:	-1090.0
No. Observations:	206	AIC:	2184.
Df Residuals:	204	BIC:	2191.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	38.6856	28.473	1.359	0.176	-17.453	94.824
value_fred_WPU39	-0.3398	0.293	-1.161	0.247	-0.917	0.237

Omnibus:	347.731	Durbin-Watson:	2.210
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	86896.432
Skew:	8.253	Prob(JB):	0.00
Kurtosis:	102.254	Cond. No.	824.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

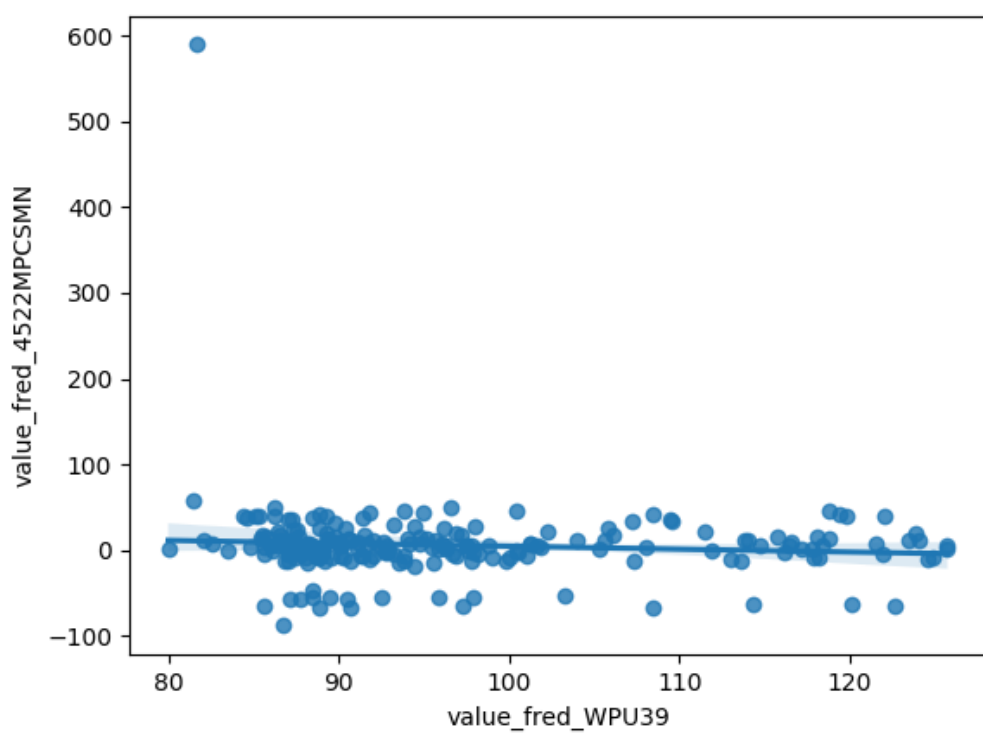


Figure 9: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-28

6.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_4522MPCSMN_detrended	R-squared:	0.014
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.009
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.884
Date:	Fri, 28 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0910
Time:	21:35:14	Log-Likelihood:	-1089.1
No. Observations:	206	AIC:	2182.
Df Residuals:	204	BIC:	2189.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-4.971e-12	3.349	-1.48e-12	1.000	-6.603	6.603
value_fred_WPU39_detrended	-0.5656	0.333	-1.698	0.091	-1.222	0.091

Omnibus:	344.090	Durbin-Watson:	2.224
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	83116.692
Skew:	8.093	Prob(JB):	0.00
Kurtosis:	100.065	Cond. No.	10.1

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

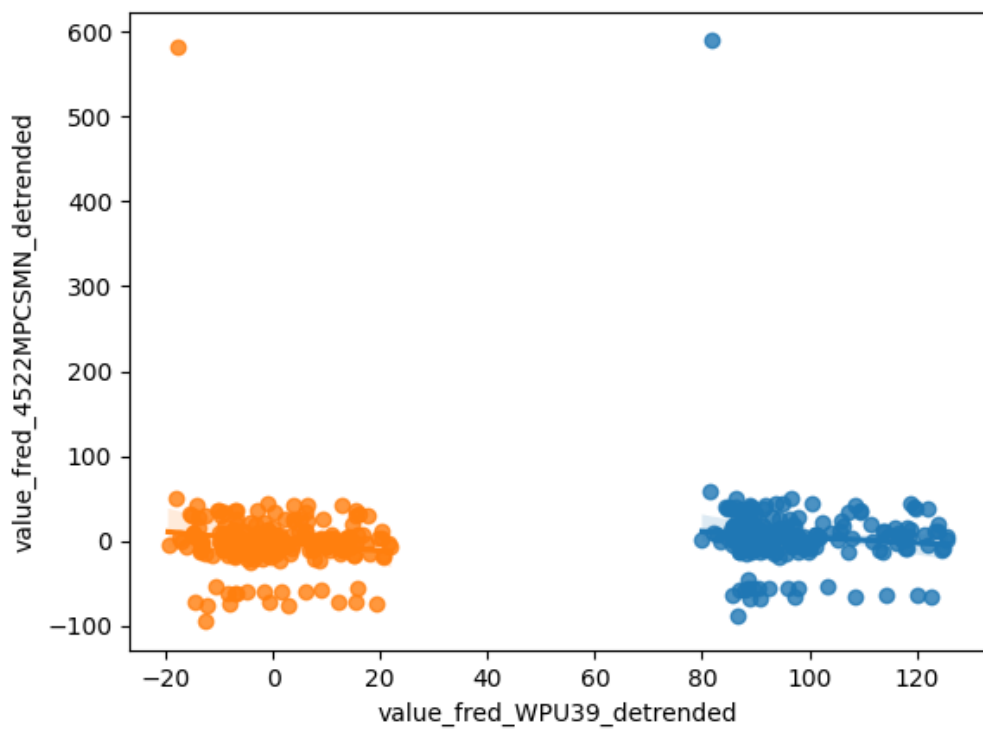


Figure 10: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-28